

Japan is almost self-reliant in terms of copper. Japan produces more copper than it consumes however, it is not self-reliant in bauxite, iron ore and mineral oil.

7. The largest copper producing country in Africa is :

- (a) South Africa (b) Zambia
(c) Kenya (d) Tanzania

U.P.U.D.A./L.D.A. (Spl) (Pre) 2010*

Ans. (b)

According to the Indian Bureau of Mines during the period in question, Zambia was the largest producer of copper on the African continent.

According to World Mineral Production, 2018-2022 (2022 data) the largest copper producing country in the African continent is D. R. Congo in this context.

8. Chiquicamata (Chile) is worldwide famous for which of the following minerals?

- (a) Copper (b) Iron
(c) Silver (d) Manganese

U.P. R.O./A.R.O. (Pre) 2017

Ans. (a)

Chiquicamata (Chile) is worldwide famous for copper mineral.

iv. The Gold

*Gold is obtained from two sources. In natural form, it is are found in the layers of quartz rocks as rock gold it is are also found as small granules in placer deposits of rivers.

*According to the figures of Indian Minerals Yearbook, 2022, Australia has the largest gold reserve. The province boasts of two of the world famous gold mines—the Coolgardie and Kalgoorlie. Gold is being extracted from Mount Morgan in Australia. The important gold deposits of USA are found in South Dakota, Black Hills,

Salt Lake, Alaska and the Yuba region of California. *In Canada, gold is being extracted from the provinces of Quebec and Ontario. *Important gold producing areas of China are Yunnan, Manchuria and Tsingling Shan. *Important gold producing areas of South Africa are Johannesburg, Mponeng, Boxberg, etc. It is famous for the extraction of gold and diamonds. *According to World Mineral Production, 2018-22 the largest producers of gold (In 2022) are—(1) China, (2) Russia, (3) Australia, (4) Canada. *According to USGS Mineral Commodity Summaries, 2025 the top three leading countries in the world in terms of gold reserves are—Australia, Russia and South Africa. *According to IMBY-2022 Hong Kong is the largest exporter in 2021-22 (P) of gold followed by the UAE and Switzerland.

1. Among the following countries, which country has recorded the highest annual gold output (in tonnes) in 2019?

- (a) Russia (b) Australia
(c) China (d) United States of America
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above.

66th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2020

Ans. (c)

According to World Mineral Production, 2018-22, the highest gold production (2022) in the world was in China. According to this data production was 372048 kg. in China, 320000 kg in Russia, 306320 kg in Australia and 192012 kg in Canada.

2. Arrange the following countries in their descending order of Gold production. Choose the correct answer using the code given below :

- (i) Australia (ii) China
(iii) South Africa (iv) U.S.A.

Code :

- (a) (i) (ii) (iii) (iv)
(b) (iii) (iv) (i) (ii)
(c) (iv) (iii) (ii) (i)
(d) (ii) (iv) (i) (iii)

U.P.P.C.S. (Spl.) (Pre) 2008

Ans. (b)

South Africa was the largest producer of gold when this question was asked. According to World Mineral Production, 2018-22 five largest producers of gold in 2022 were China > Russia > Australia > Canada > USA.

3. 'Kalgoorlie' situated in Australia is famous for –

- (a) Gold production (b) Good Climate
(c) Education (d) Poultry

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1991

Ans. (a)

According to Mineral Commodity Summaries, 2025, World's maximum gold reserves are found in Australia. Two of the important gold mines Kalgoorlie and Coolgardie are situated in Western Australia.

4. Which of the following activities is performed at Coolgardie?

- (a) Coal mining (b) Copper mining
(c) Gold mining (d) Forestry
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

60th to 62nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of the above question.